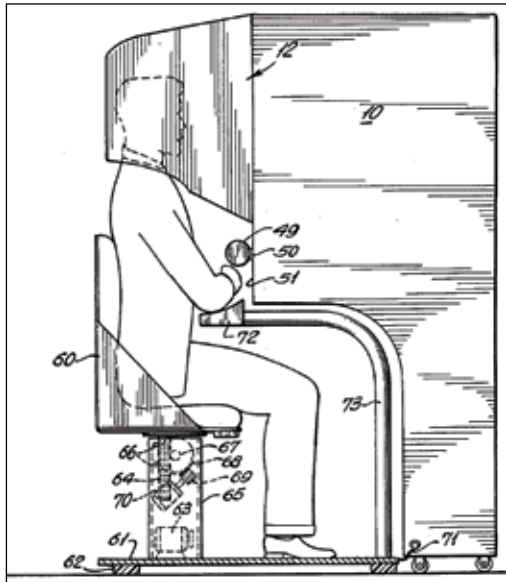


Augmented Reality dates back to the 1950s when Morton Heilig, Father of Virtual Reality, invented the Sensorama Stimulator. He dubbed it the “Experience Theater”. The idea behind it was to simulate an experience with visuals, sound, vibration, and smell, without actually being subjected to the “possible hazards of particular situations”. It was designed as a cinematic experience: it blew wind at you, vibrated the seat you sat on, played sounds to your eyes and projected a form of a stereoscopic 3D environment to the front and sides of your head; kind of like those 5D movies that we watch in theaters today. However, it was a mechanical device shaped like an arcade machine from the 80s. Oddly enough in retrospect, the project didn’t get financial backing. The first augmented reality head-mounted display system was invented by Ivan Sutherland in 1968. The device was too heavy-to-handle and was hung suspended from the ceiling and very appropriately called The Sword of Damocles. While its graphical prowess was fairly limited, it was the first step to usable-AR. It was only in the 1990s that the tech was finally christened, when a Boeing researcher Tom Caudell coined the term “augmented reality”. Julie Martin created a theatrical production in Australia called “Dancing In Cyberspace”, which used Silicon Graphics computers to let the dancers and acrobats manipulate virtual objects in real time projected into the same performance space.



Sensorama Stimulator

For most of the 20th century, AR remained a toy for the scientists. Which meant that the common man didn’t even know it existed. Bulky equipment